

to even include our own Chullachaqui, Yacuruna in our stories. That's awesome!

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Changeling: the Dreaming is the best game I have ever played.

It was one year past the end of the world, when a friend's successful Manipulation + Empathy roll (at a considerably high Difficulty) convinced me to read the Introductory Kit — astride my 'dark and mature roleplayer' high horse, I was certain something so light and colourful wasn't for me.

The next day, I bought the 2nd Edition corebook. Fifteen years later, I have every single original book and a House Ailil banner hanging in my bedroom. All because this game taught me the lesson that changed me forever as a gamer — "the greater the light, the deepest the shadows it casts". It's deceptive by how bright and happy and colourful it looks on the outside — but, inside, it hides the scariest monsters and the darkest stories.

Changeling is the best game I never played because whenever I introduce someone to it, they, like me, fall in love as they learn that same lesson — and, as the weirdo who owns all the books (and all the cantrip cards and a banner), I'm stuck running it.

Dammit.

— 'Bookmark' Ana Silva, aka Lady Anwyeth of House Fiona

Changeling: the Dreaming Storyteller @ Immortal Vigilance
Porto, Portugal



My first introduction to **Changeling** was at the end of the previous millennium, right when the prospect of a new era was imminent. **Changeling** is the combination of the exotic, fanciful fairy, undercut by the stark realization that they are doomed and trapped in a world that is increasingly alien to them. It is this otherworldliness that fascinates me. How can you play someone whose home is Arcadia, to whom the modern world is anathema? **Changeling** is ethereal, whimsical but also dark. The Fae — forever on the outside, scratching at the portals to Arcadia and Arcadia always remaining beyond reach, slipping

away like Zeno's Paradox. It's a race most can't win, but still dream about. At best, **Changeling** is about potential, of striving for the unimaginable, of joyously slipping through the portal or building your own fairy land right here: in your mind, in your room, in your story. At worst, it's the sound of dreams drying in a hostile world.

— Thaleia Flessa
Glasgow, Scotland



After the grim, structured society of the Vampires, **Changeling** was my venture into the playground of mind and memory, where slides and treehouses were castles and sticks were swords and lances — except the castles now had lords, ladies and spymasters and the blades cut more deeply than mere flesh: they cut into your soul, your innocence and that shred of extraordinary belief in the impossible, desperately fighting against the casually horrid normality we learn to accept as adults. **Changeling** was and still is about the bullied child who learned to grow a thick skin and suddenly found itself clad in armor. It's about the frustrated teenager, desperately trying to fit into a world too big or too small and being able to go on the hero's journey. It is about learning your own story, and growing into an adult who will not forget it, who will reach through the Mists to those braving the same path and say: "Stay strong, for your story will never betray you".

— Andreas Michaelides
Athens, Greece



We all most certainly have at least once in our lifetime thought that our lives already written. I've been interested in mythology and folklore since childhood. I remember the day mom bought me first two books of *Spiderwick Chronicles*; also my insistence on granny to make her tell stories about djinns was potent. I received a message from a stranger on Twitter three years ago, i had no idea about who he is. He said he saw my bio about faerie stuff and invited for his **Changeling** the Dreaming chronicle. It didn't take too long to realize he is my "Soul Brother" and game is just a summary of my life. Now we are working on a storyline/LARP project called "Gateway between Legends" based on mostly Istanbul and Anatolian folktales. Our concept maybe not so Celtic (except Galatia) but we are using Central Asian and Middle Eastern cultural references